

Canadian History





About the Course

Read Canadian history stories from the current history cycle (1800-1900). View images and reference atlases and maps to set the people and events in their time and place. Update History Charts as appropriate for student level.

This topic is included in the following course(s): History: Grades 2-3 (Canada), History: Grade 4 (Canada)



Placement & Combining Tips

History courses are on a four-year rotation. Students should follow the current Alveary rotation. Students in grades 2-4 will take the same course.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
2-4	Canadian History: Grades 2-4 1 time/week 20 min	The Kids Book of Canadian History Born!: A Foal, Five Kittens and Confederation Laura Secord's Brave Walk I Am Not a Ghost: The Canadian Pacific Railway The Spirit of Canada: Canada's Story in Legends, Fiction, Poems, and Songs Belle of Batoche

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
History: Grades 2-3 (Canada)				
				Canadian History: Grades 2-4
History: Grade 4 (Canada)				
	Canadian History: Grades 2-4		World History: Grades 4-6	



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

History: Grades 2-3 (Canada)

☐ Read the document in the Quick Links about History Timelines and Charts.

□ We encourage you to pick a biography for each term to read in the afternoons. The Bookshelf has many recommendations.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Canadian History: Grades 2-4



The Kids Book of Canadian History



Born!: A Foal, Five Kittens and Confederation



Laura Secord's Brave Walk



I Am Not a Ghost: The Canadian Pacific Railway



The Spirit of Canada: Canada's Story in Legends, Fiction, Poems, and Songs



Belle of Batoche



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Related Course Quick Links

- ∞ [History Charts & Timeline Scope & Sample](#)
- ∞ [Century Chart](#)
- ∞ [Grade 4 Canadian History Chart Prompts](#)
- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 15: History\)](#)

Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.



Canadian History: Grades 2-4

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance.



Recap

- Connect to previous lessons by asking students to recall where they left off.
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture from the reading, sharing something the teacher remembers, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, teachers might consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading this time) or repeating the previous lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage out loud. When reading to pre-readers, point to the words as you read, even if it seems like they aren't paying attention.
- Move at the student's pace for the lesson time rather than a particular number of pages. It is vitally important that teachers not try to 'force feed' a student more than they can consume in one sitting.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally.
- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill requiring the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today. Notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they say about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they

are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note. If necessary, take a break for the day.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you could ask them what they thought about the passage or ask an open-ended question.

Canadian History: Grades 2-4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 1

Introduction, The War of 1812

Materials: The Kids Book of Canadian History, globe or world atlas

PREP: Print a copy of a map of Canada. You will use this throughout the course.

∞ Map Link: Outline Map of Canada

→ INTRO

Do you know when your relatives came to Canada and what brought them here? Where did they move from? Where did they settle?

This year in Canadian history, we are learning all about Canada in the nineteenth century (between the years 1800 and 1900). At the beginning of this century, Canada was a collection of separate British colonies and was vulnerable to invasion by the newly independent nation of the United States to the south. Yet by the end of the century, Canada was a self-governing country of seven provinces and two territories, with a transcontinental railway that stretched from coast to coast. This class will explore many of the changes that took place during this time.

→ LOCATE

On a globe or world atlas, find England. Find Canada. What ocean do you have to cross?

Find the United States of America. With your finger, trace the line of the border between the United States and Canada.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.31-32 "While the fur traders" - "homes and families."

→ VIEW

Map on p.32: "Major battles in the War of 1812"

Compare this map to a modern map of Canada. What differences do you notice?

Why do you think so many battles in the War of 1812 took place near Niagara Falls and the Great Lakes?

→ MAPPING ACTIVITY

On your Map of Canada, label Queenston Heights, Toronto (called York in 1812), Montreal, the St. Lawrence River, and the Great Lakes (Lake Ontario, Lake Erie, Lake Huron, Lake Michigan, and Lake Superior).

WEEK 2 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 2

War of 1812, cont.

Materials: Famous Canadian Stories, Spirit of Canada

→ RECAP

What do you remember about why the War of 1812 started?

READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Famous Canadian Stories

∞ PDF Link: The Battle of Queenston Heights

p.139-143 "It was early" - "the United States of America."

2. Spirit of Canada

p.58-59 "The Battle of Queenston" - "know your name."

→ LISTENING ACTIVITY

Listen to Stan Rogers sing his song "MacDonnell on the Heights."

∞ Music Link: MacDonnell on the Heights

• EXTRA HELPING

Watch a Heritage Minute about how the Grand River warriors helped to defeat the Americans at Queenston Heights after the death of General Brock.

∞ Video Link: Heritage Minutes: Queenston Heights



Term 1

→ VIEW

1. Spend some time looking at this engraving of The Battle of Queenston Heights. The original engraving this one is based on is attributed to Captain James Dennis, who fought in the battle. The Americans (in blue) are crossing the Niagara River to Queenston (the right side) from Lewiston (the left side).

∞ Image Link: The Battle of Queenston Heights

2. Visit Brock's Monument at Queenston Heights. You don't need to watch the whole video, but the drone footage provides an amazing view!

∞ Video Link: Canada's Most Imposing War Memorial

WEEK 3 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 3

Laura Secord

Materials: Kids Book of Canadian History, Famous Canadian Stories

→ RECAP

What do you remember from last week about the Battle of Queenston Heights?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Kids Book of Canadian History

p.33 "Laura Secord walked" - "in a common cause."

2. Famous Canadian Stories

∞ PDF Link: Laura Secord

p.147-150 "In a churchyard" - "heroines of Canadian history."

- How do you think Laura Secord must have felt on her long walk?

→ VIEW

Visit the monument to Laura Secord.

∞ Image Link: Laura Ingersoll Secord Monument

WEEK 4 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 4

Laura Secord, cont.

Materials: Laura Secord's Brave Walk

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Laura Secord from the last class?

→ INTRO

Over the next two lessons, you will read *Laura Secord's Brave Walk*, an engaging and beautifully illustrated story book that brings this episode of Canadian history to life by introducing young readers to the War of 1812 through the courage of one Canadian.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"'Laura,' James Secord said" - "and up the stairs."

- What do you think life was like for Laura Secord and her family in Queenston? Spend some time looking at the illustrations today to look for clues that can help answer this question.

Canadian History: Grades 2-4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 5 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 5

Laura Secord, cont.; End of War

Materials: Laura Secord's Brave Walk, Kids Book of Canadian History

→ RECAP

What did you read about Laura Secord last week?

PREP: Read the "Author's Historical Note" on the last page of the book and decide how much information you'd like to share with your students.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Laura Secord's Brave Walk

"James," Laura whispered - "She had done it!"

2. Kids Book of Canadian History

p.33 "The War Ends" - "hide the burn marks."

• Why do you think the War of 1812 helped people living in the various British colonies to start thinking of themselves as Canadians?

→ VIEW

Laura Secord took her message to Captain James FitzGibbon, an Irishman who served in the British army and was mentored by General Brock. FitzGibbon survived the war and eventually returned to England. He sat for a photo in his army uniform around 1860, when he was in his 80s.

∞ Image Link: Colonel James FitzGibbon

Did you know photographs have been around for nearly 200 years?

Initially, photographs had very long exposure times, so people needed to sit very still with an unchanging expression.

• EXTRA HELPING

Watch a Heritage Minute about Laura Secord's journey.

∞ Video Link: Heritage Minutes: Laura Secord

WEEK 6 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 6

The Red River Settlement

Materials: Kids Book of Canadian History, Famous Canadian Stories, map or atlas of Canada

→ RECAP

What did you read about Laura Secord last week?

→ INTRO

While the War of 1812 was at its height in Upper and Lower Canada to the east, a Scottish nobleman named Thomas Douglas, 5th Earl of Selkirk, was working to establish a colony on the prairies to the west, at the intersection of the Red and Assiniboine Rivers, near what is now Winnipeg. Selkirk had received a large grant of land from the Hudson Bay Company and wanted to create a farming community to support many poor Scottish highlanders and Irish peasants, who had lost their homes and livelihoods due to various upheavals at the end of the eighteenth century. This community, known as the Red River Settlement, would come to play a large role in the history of immigrants to the prairies, Métis peoples, the province of Manitoba, and the history of Canada as a nation.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. The Kids Book of Canadian History

p.30 "The Red River Settlement" - "centre of Métis life."

2. Famous Canadian Stories

∞ PDF Link: The Selkirk Settlement

p.169-172 "My Lord" - "one hundred and forty years ago."

• DEFINITIONS

Métis: from a French adjective meaning "mixed," the word Métis refers to people who have both Indigenous and European ancestry. The Métis are one of three recognized Indigenous groups, the others being First Nations and Inuit.

Canadian History: Grades 2-4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ MAPPING ACTIVITY

Look at a map or atlas of Manitoba and locate the Red River and Fort Douglas (present-day Winnipeg). Find the Hudson Bay on the same map so you can see the route the settlers took.

Compare this modern map to a map of the land given to Selkirk:

∞ Map Link: Map showing the Selkirk Land Grant in 1811

On your Map of Canada, draw and label the Red River, and mark Winnipeg and Hudson's Bay.

WEEK 7 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 7

Rebellions of 1837-1838

📖 Materials: The Kids Book of Canadian History, Spirit of Canada

→ RECAP

What did you learn last week about the Red River Settlement?

→ INTRO

How do we choose our government in Canada and in our provinces and territories? Do you think it has always been this way in Canada? Today we will learn about frustrations towards the government in the 1830s, which would eventually lead to the form of government we recognize today.

→ VIEW

Remember that in 1791, the large Province of Quebec was divided into Upper and Lower Canada, roughly corresponding to the provinces of Ontario and Quebec today.

∞ Link: Upper & Lower Canada in 1791

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. The Kids Book of Canadian History

p.34-35 "During the 1820s" - "given any more power."

2. Spirit of Canada

p.60-62 "In the years after" - "letter R in his pocket."

WEEK 8 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 8

Rebellions of 1837-1838, cont.

📖 Materials: Kids Book of Canadian History, Spirit of Canada

→ RECAP

Why were the settlers in Upper and Lower Canada unhappy?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. The Kids Book of Canadian History

p.36-37 "Rebellion in Lower Canada" - "Newfoundland in 1855."

• How did the colonies of British North America change after 1841 and again after 1848?

2. The Spirit of Canada

p.63 "William Lyon Mackenzie" - "the day and the hour."

3. The Spirit of Canada

p.64-65 "Un Canadien errant" - "last dying breath."

∞ Music Link: Un canadien errant

• EXTRA HELPING

Watch two Heritage Minutes about the reforms that were brought about by the rebellions in the 1830s:

∞ Video Link: Heritage Minutes: Baldwin & LaFontaine

(Parents may wish to preview this one for younger students since it does dramatize a violent scene)

∞ Video Link: Heritage Minutes:

Responsible Government
Queen Victoria voices her approval of the reforms.

Canadian History: Grades 2-4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 9 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 9

Settlers - Canadian Crusoes

Materials: Spirit of Canada

→ RECAP

What did you learn last week about responsible government?

→ INTRO

Have you ever been camping? What do you need to bring with you if you are going to live outdoors? What if you didn't have any stores nearby? What would you use for clothing, shelter, and food?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.76-81 "The first population boom" - "or any liquid."

WEEK 10 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 10

Settlers - Roughing it in the Bush

Materials: Spirit of Canada

→ RECAP

What do you remember about what you learned last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.82-85 "Susanna Moodie" - "try to grow."

- Margaret Atwood's poem describes Susanna Moodie's experience of two different fires. How does she use repeated words and images in the poem to show the similarity of the two fires?

WEEK 11 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 11

The Northwest Passage

Materials: Famous Canadian Stories, Spirit of Canada

→ RECAP

What do you remember about what you learned last week?

→ INTRO

After the Treaty of Ghent (signed in 1814), which ended the war between Britain and the United States, and the Treaty of Paris (signed in 1815) that effectively ended the Napoleonic Wars, Britain was left with a large navy and fleet with much less to do. One new peacetime venture for the British Navy was scientific exploration, and numerous ships were sent to remote parts of the globe, including several ships attempting to find the Northwest Passage through the Arctic. Today we will read about one ill-fated voyage, Sir John Franklin's expedition.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Famous Canadian Stories

∞ PDF Link: Franklin Expedition

p.40-42 "The greatest mystery" - "for another man."

2. Spirit of Canada

p.44-45 "The story of John Franklin" - "back home again"

Listen to a recording of Stan Rogers singing his folk song about the search for the Northwest Passage.

∞ Music Link: Northwest Passage

- How many explorers' names do you recognize in the song?

Canadian History: Grades 2-4

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Term 1

WEEK 12 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Famous Canadian Stories
Laura Secord's Brave Walk
The Spirit of Canada



Canadian History: Grades 2-4

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Term 2

WEEK 1 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 13

Life at Mid-Century

Materials: Kids Book of Canadian History, Spirit of Canada

PREP: In The Spirit of Canada, parents and teachers may wish to preview the letter and decide how best to discuss its difficult topics with their younger students.

→ INTRO

In Term 2, we will learn about what life was like around the time of Canada's Confederation on July 1, 1867.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. The Kids Book of Canadian History
p.38-39 "The 1840s to 1860s" - "to farm or start businesses."

2. The Spirit of Canada
p.107-108 "Shinguacouse was an Ojibwa" - "pale-faced bad brother."

WEEK 2 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 14

Life at Mid-Century - Underground Railroad

Materials: Kids Book of Canadian History, Spirit of Canada

→ RECAP

What do you remember from last week about what life was like in the 1840s and 1850s?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. The Kids Book of Canadian History
p.39 "After 1834" - "others to safety."

2. The Spirit of Canada
p.66-68 "There were black slaves" - "the drinkin' gourd."
Listen to a recording of Follow the Drinkin' Gourd.
∞ Music Link: Eric Bibb: Follow the Drinking Gourd

3. The Spirit of Canada
p.69-70 "The Underground Railroad" - "coloured men are free."

4. The Spirit of Canada
(This reading is optional, if you have extra time during the lesson. Parents and teachers may want to preview the story for younger students.)
p.71-75 "Even in Canada" - "'My dearest friend,' it began...."

WEEK 3 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 15

Life at Mid-Century, cont.; Logging

Materials: Kids Book of Canadian History, Spirit of Canada

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the readings last week?

→ INTRO

The 1840s and 1850s were a time of great changes in the colonies; as more and more people immigrated to Canada, the population grew, and with it grew industries, but also the need for finding places for people to live and work.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. The Kids Book of Canadian History

• EXTRA HELPING

The sailing ship Marco Polo met its fate in a storm off the coast of Cavendish, and its running aground was witnessed by a young L.M. Montgomery, who later wrote an essay about it for the Montreal Daily Witness (March 5, 1891). You can read her essay [here](#).

∞ PDF Link: The Wreck of the Marco Polo



Term 2

p.40-41 "Everything east of British Columbia" - "the Oregon Territory."

2. The Spirit of Canada

p.86 "Forest have long" - "their traditional homelands."

p.89-93 "In the novel" - "such risks again."

p.94-95 "Lumbering in British Columbia" - "run the hotcakes raw."

Listen along as you read the words to this song!

∞ Music Link: Way Up the Ucletaw

→ VIEW

Spend a few moments looking at this painting of the Marco Polo clipper ship by the British painter Montague Dawson. How does he show the viewer that this ship is in motion?

∞ Image Link: The Marco Polo by Montague Dawson

WEEK 4 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 16

Confederation

📖 Materials: The Kids Book of Canadian History, Born!

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the readings from last week?

→ INTRO

How did a group of colonies with so many differences—geographic, linguistic, cultural, historical, and ethnic—join together to form the country we now call Canada? Over the next few weeks, we will read about the events leading up to July 1, 1867, and see the famous Charlottetown Conference of 1864 through the eyes of nine-year old twins Gabriel and Grace, who are eagerly anticipating the birth of new kittens, a new foal, and a new country!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. The Kids Book of Canadian History

p.42-43 "By the 1860s" - "to the Pacific Ocean."

2. Born!

p.2-8 "Dear Reader" - "two buckets of fresh water."

• IMPORTANT DATES

George-Étienne Cartier (1814-1873)

Sir John A. Macdonald (1815-1891)

George Brown (1818-1880)

WEEK 5 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 17

Confederation, cont.

📖 Materials: Born!

→ RECAP

What do you remember from last week about the events leading up to Canada's Confederation?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.9-21 "There was a commotion" - "if you need me, *ma chère*."

→ VIEW

1. Learn more about the artist Robert Harris, who appears as a character in Born!

∞ Link: Robert Harris - National Gallery of Canada

In 1883, Robert Harris was commissioned to paint a work commemorating the 1864 Quebec Conference, titled Meeting of the Delegates of British North America to Settle the Terms of Confederation, or, more commonly, The Fathers of Confederation. The original painting was destroyed in the Parliament Hill fire of 1916, but a preparatory sketch still exists. His other most famous painting - Meeting of the School Trustees - appeared on a Canadian postage stamp in 1980.

∞ Image Link: Meeting of the School Trustees

Canadian History: Grades 2-4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

2. A clearer view of the circus advertisement.
∞ Image Link: Slaymaker & Nichols Olympic Circus

WEEK 6 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 18

Confederation, cont.

Materials: Born!

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.22-32 "Because of the great excitement" - "and went home."

→ VIEW

Look at this map of what British North America looked like before the Confederation of Canada. What do you notice that is different from today?

∞ Map Link: British North America circa 1823 map

WEEK 7 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 19

Confederation, cont.

Materials: Born!

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.33-46 "Late in the afternoon" - "Canada was only an idea."

WEEK 8 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 20

Confederation, cont.

Materials: Spirit of Canada

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.114-116 "On July 1, 1867" - "the north-west."

• How do you think you would have felt if you were alive back then to celebrate Canada's Confederation? What activities sound the most fun to you?

2. p.117-118 "When the Charlottetown Conference" - "birthright was sold."
Listen to a performance of the Anti-Confederation Song, recorded only ten years after Newfoundland joined Canada in 1949.

∞ Music Link: Alan Mills - Anti-Confederation Song (1959)

WEEK 9 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 21

Red River Rising - Manitoba

Materials: The Kids Book of Canadian History, The Spirit of Canada

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week about July 1, 1867?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

• **IMPORTANT DATES**
Louis Riel (1844-1885)

Canadian History: Grades 2-4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

1. The Kids Book of Canadian History
p.45-46 "Two years later" - "Nile River in Egypt."

2. The Spirit of Canada (optional)
p.109-111 "Willie Dunn" - "which it does entail." You can listen along at the link below:
∞ Music Link: Ballad of Crowfoot
As it is described in The Spirit of Canada, The Ballad of Crowfoot is a "haunting" reflection on how detrimental many of Canada's policies and treaties were for Indigenous people over the course of one man's life in the nineteenth century. This tragic song may be best suited for older students.

WEEK 10 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 22

From Sea to Sea

Materials: The Kids Book of Canadian History, Famous Canadian Stories

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. The Kids Book of Canadian History
p.47-48 "One year after" - "he could do it."

2. Famous Canadian Stories

∞ PDF Link: Alexander Graham Bell
p.278-280 "On March 10, 1876" - "the telephone had come."

• EXTRA HELPING

Learn more about the history of "O Canada" by reading the lyrics of previous versions.

∞ Article Link: O Canada

• IMPORTANT DATES

Alexander Graham Bell (1847-1922)

WEEK 11 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 23

The Great Northwest

Materials: The Kids Book of Canadian History, Belle of Batoche

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. The Kids Book of Canadian History
p.49-50 "The land bought" - "in November 1885."

→ INTRO

The next book we will read, Belle of Batoche, is the story of a young Métis girl whose family is caught up in the North-West Resistance, and its final battle in Batoche, Saskatchewan. Belle is an ordinary eleven-year old girl who helps her parents, serves at her church, and is preoccupied with a rivalry with another girl at school when she is suddenly at the centre of the 1885 Riel Rebellion.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

2. Belle of Batoche
p.1-7 "Belle emerged" - "feel very special."

• What are your first impressions of Belle if you were meeting her as a new friend?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Belle of Batoche is an engaging story written in a simple style. It is an excellent option for an independent read for ready students.

WEEK 12 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Canadian History: Grades 2-4

[Click THIS text or
scan the QR code
for links.](#)



Term 2

Questions will come from:
Born! A Foal, Five Kittens, and Confederation
The Spirit of Canada
The Kids Book of Canadian History

Canadian History: Grades 2-4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 1 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 25

Belle of Batoche, cont.

Materials: Belle of Batoche

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.8-19 "Belle rounded the corner" - "let Sarah beat her."

- What are your first impressions of the character of Sarah?
 - Read Wordsworth's poem for yourself, and discuss the two girls' interpretations. Do you see the images in your mind?
- ∞ Link: I Wandered Lonely as a Cloud

WEEK 2 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 26

Belle of Batoche, cont.

Materials: Belle of Batoche

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.21-31 "That night, Belle" - "that she would win."

- What do you think of the embroidery competition? Do you think it is a fair way to decide who will be the bell ringer?

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

This video gives an excellent introduction to the history of Batoche and the land around it. Watch especially for a brief appearance of Jacqueline Guest, the author of Belle of Batoche!

∞ Video Link: Batoche National Historic Site – Batoche and Tourond's Coulée: A Landscape Coming Alive

WEEK 3 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 27

Belle of Batoche, cont.

Materials: Belle of Batoche

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.31-43 "While working on" - "that people talked."

→ VIEW

Learn more about elements of Métis culture, many of which are mentioned in Belle of Batoche: Métis sash, Red River cart, Red River jig, Métis flag, cuisine, beadwork, and fiddle. Follow the "Learn More" links under each heading.

∞ Link: Symbols of Métis Culture

WEEK 4 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 28

Belle of Batoche, cont.

Materials: Belle of Batoche

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week?

★ TEACHER NOTE

In order to get through the whole novel, some lessons have slightly longer than 10-minute readings. You might decide to do the extra reading during the afternoon.

Canadian History: Grades 2-4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.44-59 "Belle had to do" - "she didn't think so."

- Are you suspicious of Sarah's behaviour, too? What do you think will happen next?

WEEK 5 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 29

Belle of Batoche, cont.

Materials: Belle of Batoche

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.60-73 "All the way home" - "cheated in the contest."

- Belle suspects Sarah of cheating, and Sarah accuses Belle of making up stories. How do you think they should work through this conflict? What do you think of their actions?

WEEK 6 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 30

Belle of Batoche, cont.

Materials: Belle of Batoche

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.74-90 "The sun had not crested" - "bell from the church!"

→ VIEW

1. While reading, consult this map of Batoche and a larger map of Saskatchewan in 1885.

∞ Map Link: Map of Batoche National Historic Site

∞ Map Link: Troop Movement & Battles, 1885 Resistance

2. The attack on the Northcote steamer ship actually happened. Here is an illustration of the event published in the "Illustrated War News" periodical on August 29, 1885.

∞ Image Link: The Steamer "Northcote" Running the Gauntlet at Batoche May 8th, 1885

WEEK 7 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 31

Belle of Batoche, cont.

Materials: Belle of Batoche

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.91-105 "Belle looked back" - "shortcut to our house."



Term 3

WEEK 8 ☐ 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 32

Belle of Batoche, cont.

☐ Materials: Belle of Batoche

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.105-119 "As the afternoon" - "they were fast asleep."

- What are the emergency supplies that Belle goes back home to get? How are they different from emergency supplies that you might pack today? What are some other ways that shelter, clothing, food, and medicines have changed over 140 years?

WEEK 9 ☐ 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 33

Belle of Batoche, cont.

☐ Materials: Belle of Batoche

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.120-135 "They were awoken" - "Patrice Tourond."

- What did you think of the ending of the book? Why do you think the dangerous days of hiding helped Belle and Sarah to become friends? What changed?

WEEK 10 ☐ 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 34

The Canadian Pacific Railway

☐ Materials: The Kids Book of Canadian History, I Am Not a Ghost

PREP: In *I Am Not a Ghost*, read Foreword (p.6-7) and Historical Notes (p.36-37) and decide how best to share this information with your student(s). This beautifully illustrated story offers an opportunity to discuss with your children what it means to treat others as image-bearers of the image of God.

→ INTRO

The last two classes cover the completion of the Canadian Pacific Railway in 1885, which had been one of the conditions for British Columbia joining Canada in 1871. This project came at a high cost, however, as the work was often dangerous, and the Chinese labourers who were brought to Canada as railway workers were underpaid, undernourished, and mistreated. *I Am Not a Ghost* tells the story of one temporary Chinese worker whose life was saved through the kindness of one person.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. *The Kids Book of Canadian History*
p.50 "Surveyors and engineers" - "July 1886."

2. *I Am Not a Ghost*
p.8-22 "Johnny! You!" - "We all healed."

- In the first half of the story, we see the main character being treated very differently by two people: the foreman and Mrs. Douglas. How do they treat him differently? Does this story remind you of any other stories you know?



Term 3

WEEK 11 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 35

The Canadian Pacific Railway, cont.

Materials: I Am Not a Ghost, The Spirit of Canada

→ **RECAP**

What do you remember from your reading last week?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

- 1. I Am Not a Ghost
p.24-35 "After three weeks" - "we are proud Canadians."
- 2. The Spirit of Canada
p.122-125 "Canada's first public railway line" - "and our toil."
Listen along to the song at the following link:
∞ Music Link: Canadian Railroad Trilogy

• **EXTRA HELPING**

Have you ever seen the photograph of the last spike being hammered into the railway at Craigellachie, BC? Did you notice the young boy front and centre? See the photograph and learn more about him.
∞ **Article Link:** The Kid in the Last Spike

John A. Macdonald's wife Agnes had a unique way of riding the train! Read her story "The Lady and the Cowcatcher" in The Spirit of Canada p.130-133, and see a photograph of her from 1887.
∞ **Article Link:** History Corner -1887- Lady Agnes Macdonald

WEEK 12 20m Canadian History: Grades 2-4 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ **EXAMS**

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Kids Book of Canadian History
Belle of Batoche
I am not a Ghost

Canadian History: Grades 2-4

Examination

- Term 1** · (Famous Canadian Stories and Laura Secord's Brave Walk) Tell the story of Laura Secord. OR (The Spirit of Canada) Describe how the characters in Catharine Parr Traill's Canadian Crusoes were able to survive in the forest.
- Term 2** · (Born! and The Kids Book of Canadian History) What were some of the reasons why the provinces wanted to come together to form the Dominion of Canada in 1867? OR (The Spirit of Canada and The Kids Book of Canadian History) Tell all you remember about what life was like around the middle of the nineteenth century. What sorts of work did people do?
- Term 3** · (Belle of Batoche and The Kids Book of Canadian History) Tell all you know about Métis culture in nineteenth-century Canada—this can include historical events and/or the Métis way of life. OR (I am not a Ghost and The Kids Book of Canadian History) Why and how did the Canadian Pacific Railway get built? Why was its completion such an important event in Canadian history?